

Vanishing Boundaries

KETA SHAH AND VARUN SHAH | WORKSHOP INC.

Workshop Inc. is currently exploring the concept of the Warm Monolith. As principal designers, Keta and Varun Shah explain, these days they often wrap an entire kitchen in a single material, typically walnut or teak veneer; from the cabinetry to the ceiling. This immersive envelope makes the boundaries of the room disappear.

In this Ahmedabad project, the kitchen is a lesson in textural layering. Dark fluted backsplashes and matte black appliances act as quiet punctuation marks, while the kitchen island is treated as a sculptural piece of stone. "The journey begins in a bold black and white Indian travertine foyer, which opens into living spaces where soft grey marble, wooden wall panels, and a full-height blue fabric screen create warmth and quiet colour," says Keta. The kitchen integrates seamlessly with a wooden ceiling and contrasting cylindrical fixtures.











Soul of Materiality

ZAFAR MASUD CHAUDHARY AND SARAH CHOUDHARY | HABITAT ARCHITECTS

At Habitat Architects, the kitchen has evolved from a collection of cabinets into a seamless architectural gesture. For Zafar Masud Chaudhary, CEO and founding partner and Sarah Choudhary, creative director and senior interior designer, the modern kitchen is defined by quiet control, a space that moves away from visual fragmentation toward floor-to-ceiling continuity. In a 340 sq ft Gurgaon residence, this was realised through a U-shaped layout where cabinetry rises nearly three meters to meet the ceiling, allowing the room to read as one solid volume rather than a series of units.

Since the practice champions material honesty, they have opted for stone that breathes and timber that ages naturally over synthetic, heavily coated surfaces. By treating the central island as a monolithic block of honed marble rather than a piece of furniture, the design team ensures the kitchen feels integrated into the home's bones. "When the proportions are resolved, the kitchen doesn't need articulation. It holds itself," says Zafar. This restraint allows natural light to become a primary design tool, shifting the mood of the textures throughout the day. Ultimately, the goal is personal resonance over performance; as Sarah notes, "A kitchen should feel like it belongs to you before it tries to impress anyone else."